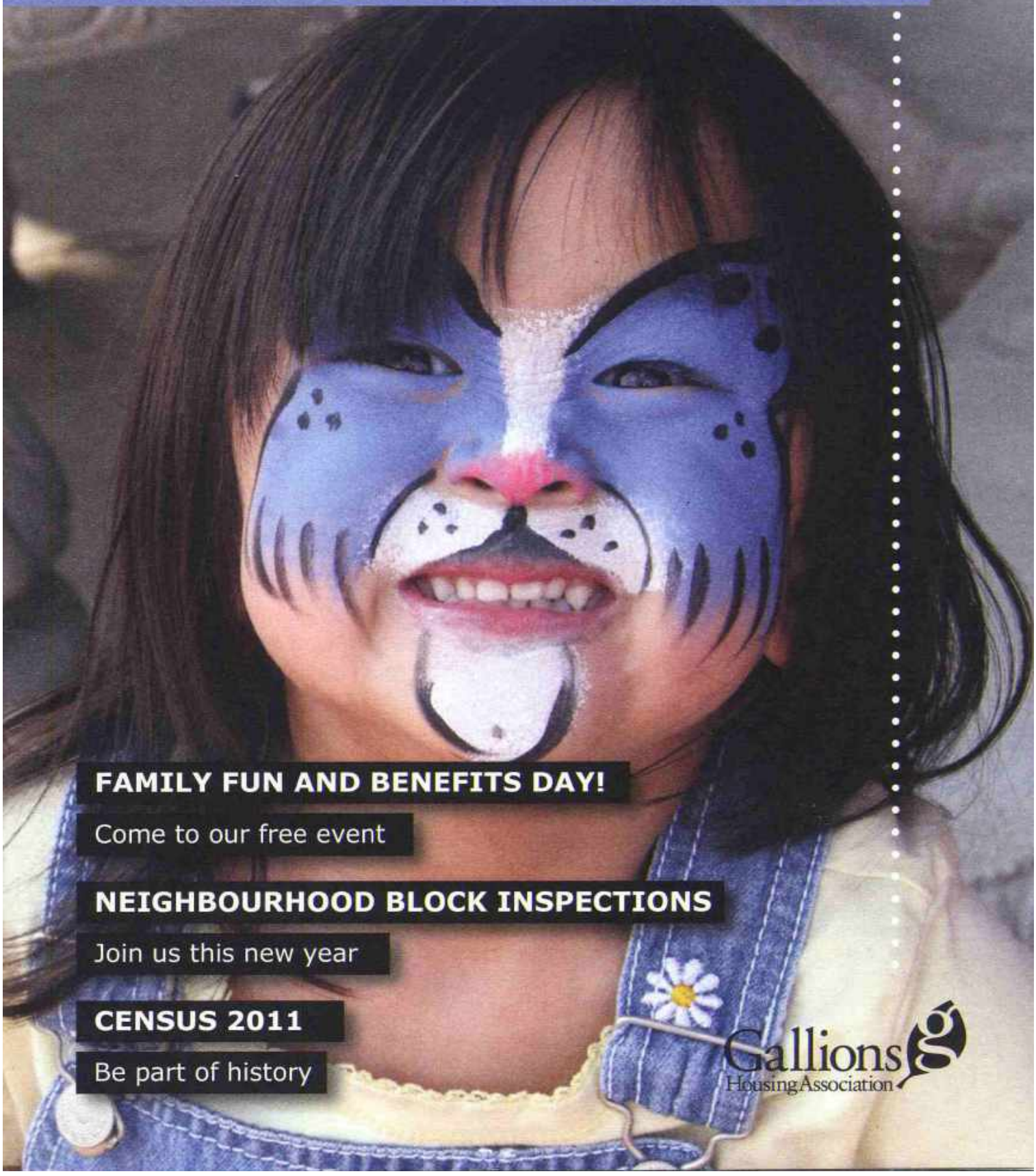
thamesview

Your magazine from Gallions • gallionsha.co.uk • January 2011



FAMILY FUN AND BENEFITS DAY!

Come to our free event

NEIGHBOURHOOD BLOCK INSPECTIONS

Join us this new year

CENSUS 2011

Be part of history

Gallions Housing Association

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WELCOME

Happy new year to you! If your 2011 diary isn't full yet make a note to come along to our Family Fun and Benefits Day in February, where you can find out about the changes to the benefits system, get advice and enjoy some fun activities all for free!

In this edition we have more articles than ever from Gallions Resident's Group on the Tenants View pages so make sure you check them out and let us know your feedback and ideas. If you are looking for a new hobby in 2011 why not join the Open Gateway Craft Club or visit the Pop-In Parlour - more details on page nine.

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CAREERS AT GALLIONS

We publicise all our current employment opportunities on our website. We are always looking for talented individuals to join our team so if you can't find a vacancy that suits you, just sign up to our talent pool.

COMPLAINTS, COMMENTS AND COMPLIMENTS

Please contact us if you have something to share about our service. We don't mind whether it's good or bad because we use all feedback to improve what we do.
Complaints@gallionsha.co.uk • www.gallionsha.co.uk • 0800 83 84 81

PUBLICATION DETAILS

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Gallions Housing Association

MAKE YOUR MARK IN HISTORY!



Sunday 27 March 2011 is census day! The census is a count of the population in the UK. Every 10 years everyone is asked the same questions on the same day to give a complete picture of the nation.

The census tells the Office of National Statistics how many people live in the UK and what types of services they need now and are likely to need in the future. It helps the Government and local councils to plan and budget for important services such as transport, housing, health and schools.

The questions in the census ask about the people in your home and their lifestyles. The information is used only for the census and for no other reason – it's not passed on to any other party like Gallions, the Council or the Government.

So please don't ignore the purple form when it comes through the door. It is a legal requirement to complete and submit the form and you could be prosecuted and fined £1000 if you don't take part in the census.

The census will need to be filled in by the householder - this means the person or people that pay the main household bills. You can complete the census online if that's easier, or get help filling it in if you need it.

There are also a range of temporary census career opportunities available. Visit https://censusjobs.co.uk to find out more and to apply.

For more information visit www.census.gov.uk or call 01329 444 972.

FAMILY FUN & BENEFITS DAY!

- Do you currently claim Incapacity Benefit?
- Are you claiming Housing Benefit and have a child of working age living with you?
- Are you sure you're claiming all the benefits you are entitled to?
- Do you find the benefits system confusing?
- Would you like a free goodie bag and to be entered into a prize draw?
- Would your children enjoy free face painting, balloon modelling or arts and crafts?

If you answered yes to any of these questions our Family Fun and Benefits Day is for you!

At this event you will be able to ask our team any questions you have about your benefit entitlement and find out the latest about welfare reform. We will be available for an informal chat or a full benefits health check.

Plus, there will be free refreshments, fun activities for your family and the chance to win £50 in shopping vouchers just for attending!

Wednesday 23rd February 2011
10.30am until 7.30pm
(pop in at any time!)
Manor Close Community Centre,
40 Manor Close, Thamesmead,
SE28 8EY.

Buses 177, 229, 401, 472, 601, 602, 669 all stop at Nickleby Close, just a couple of minutes walk away.

Contact us on 0800 83 84 81 to find out more or to confirm your place. See you there!

BENEFITS ARE CHANGING

Over the coming months and years the government will be changing the way the benefits system works. Use our timeline to find out more or come along to our event on 23 February 2011 for free benefits advice.

January 2011
Health in pregnancy grant is stopped.

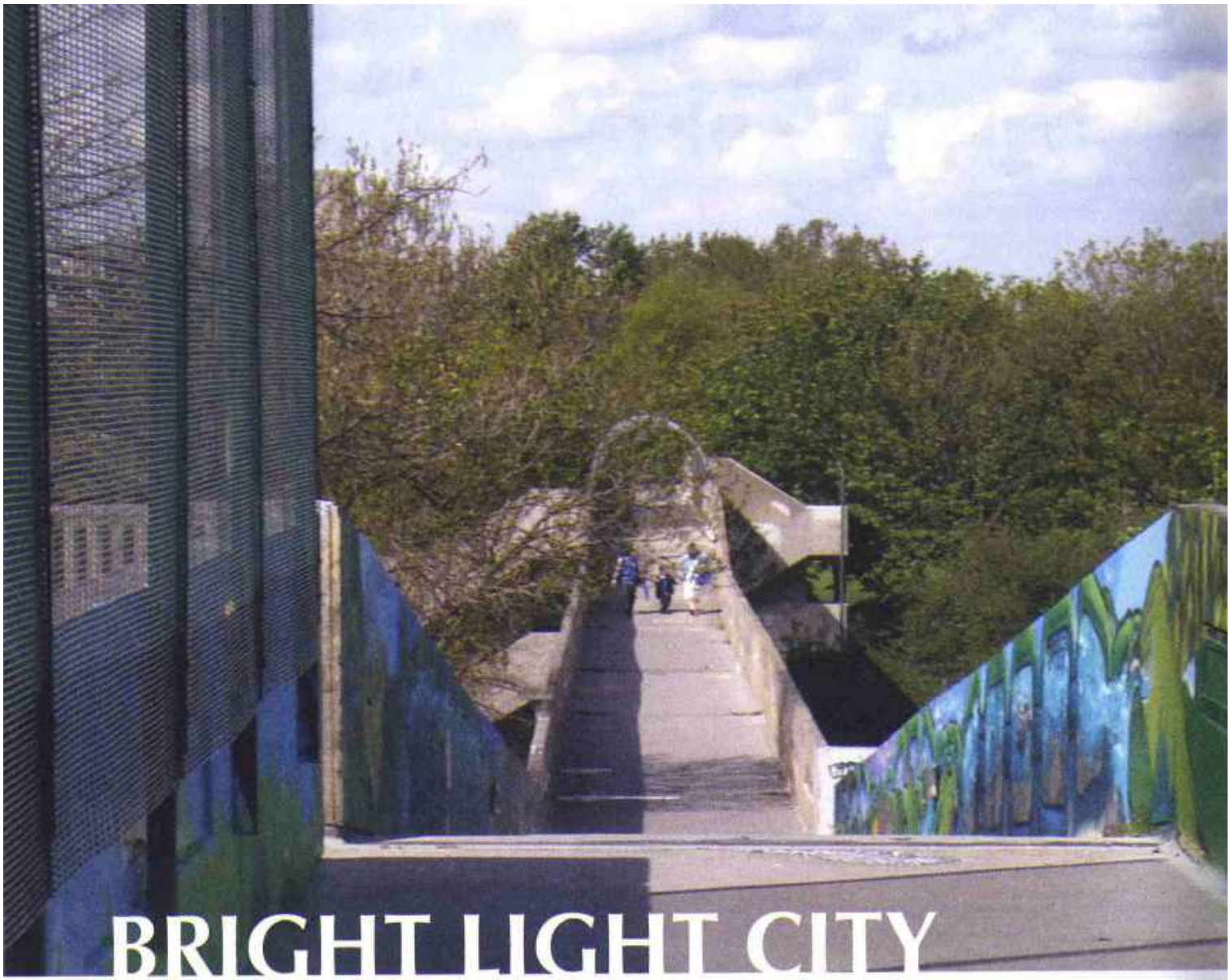
February 2011
Incapacity Benefit claims to be re-assessed. Incapacity Benefit, Severe Disablement Allowance and Income Support paid because of illness or disability is being phased out. All existing claims will be reviewed by Jobcentre Plus, to see if people are capable of work or qualify for other benefits.

April 2011
Child tax credits and working tax credits will change.

April 2011
Child Benefit frozen for 3 years.

April 2011
Housing Benefit changes for families with children over 18. If you claim Housing Benefit and have an adult son, daughter, relative or friend living with you the amount of Housing Benefit you receive could reduce.

April 2011
Eligibility for Sure Start maternity grant is restricted to first child.



BRIGHT LIGHT CITY

As part of the Belvedere Green Links project, lighting along the walkway between Lesnes Abbey and Southmere Park is being changed to help make the area brighter for users of the green chain walk.

Local residents told us that lighting along the walkway was very important to them and they would feel safer using it if it was improved.

Belvedere Green Links is currently working on a number of regeneration projects in the area.

It is managed directly by the London Borough of Bexley and funded by the Homes and Communities agency, the European Regional Development Fund and the London Development Agency.

The lighting project is due to start in January 2011 and it should take eight weeks to complete.

For more information and to see upcoming events visit www.belvederegreenlinks.org.uk or call 020 8303 7777.

IMPORTANT INFORMATION FOR RESIDENTS

We recently changed our call centre and reception opening hours so we can provide a better service during our busiest times.

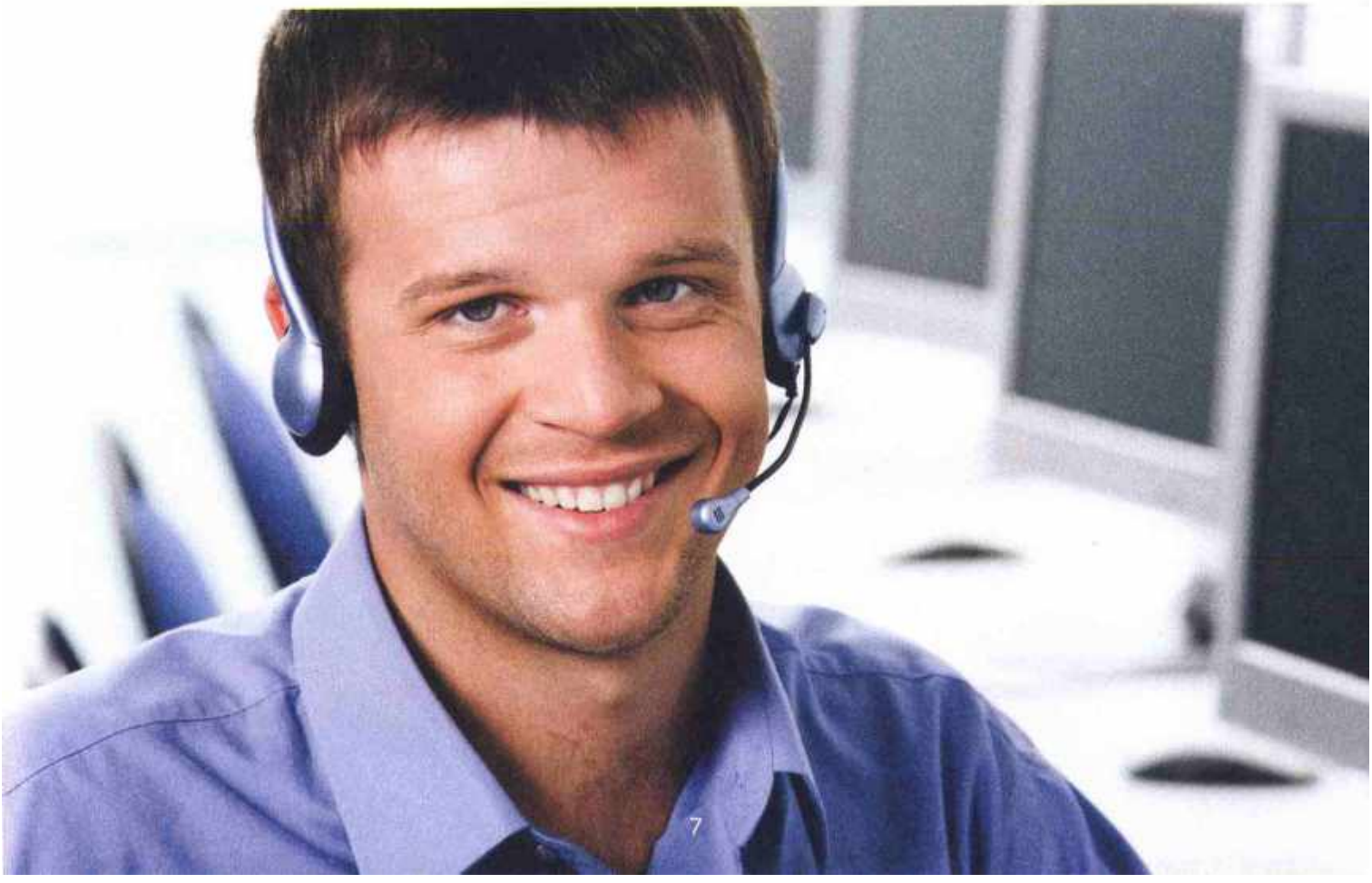
Our reception at Harrow Manor Way, Thamesmead is now open from 9am until 5pm on Monday, Tuesday, Thursday and Friday and 9am until 6pm on Wednesdays. Our call centre is available on 0800 83 84 81 for all types of enquiry from 8am until 6pm Monday to Friday.

An emergency telephone service is in place from 6pm and 8am, Monday to Friday and at weekends and bank holidays.

In late March 2011 our office in Harrow Manor Way will close and we will open a new office in Titmuss Avenue (at the old police station).

At this time we will also be changing our main contact number. We will be introducing a dedicated repairs line to help improve our service as well as offering a general housing enquiries line. Remember that you can also use our website to report a repair and find out information about our services.

We will write to all our residents nearer the time to let you know the exact dates of the changes and details of the new phone numbers.



WELCOME TO KENT!



Just Right is a new under occupation scheme that helps people move from a large property in London to a more manageable home on the Kent coast.

Over the past year we have moved tenants to Cheriton, Dymchurch, Folkestone, Hythe and St Mary's Bay.

It has proved so popular that we have extended the scheme and are now offering properties in Herne Bay, Whitstable, Deal and Walmer.

If you are a tenant living in a council or housing association property with 3 or more bedrooms and need something smaller (1 or 2 bedrooms) this may be 'Just Right' for you.

Priority will be given to those living in 4 or 5 bedroom homes and those with family or work on the Kent coast.

If you would like to apply contact Hazel Church on 0800 83 84 81 or email hchurch@gallionsha.co.uk.

HOUSING OPTIONS FOR YOU

Housing Options is a large online list of affordable housing schemes in London. If you are unable to afford to buy your own home or rent a good quality home on the open market then they can help you.

All you need to do is fill in an application form online to get access to all the schemes across London, including homes from Gallions. You can search and apply for homes available on the following schemes: New Build HomeBuy (formally known as shared ownership), Open Market HomeBuy, Intermediate Rent and Re-Sales. You will be able to find new build properties as well as older homes.

To check your eligibility and to start looking for a new home visit www.housingoptions.co.uk or call 0844 406 9997.



FEELING CRAFTY?



The Open Gateway Craft Club is a group for people who enjoy cutting, gluing, sewing, painting and chatting.

Beginners and experienced crafters are welcome to take part in card making, scrapbooking and other activities. The group meets on Mondays, Tuesdays, Thursdays and the first Saturday of the month at the Open Gateway United Church, 62-64 Battery Road, West Thamesmead, SE28 0JT.

There is no set fee to take part but participants are asked to make a donation, which could be money, craft supplies or a packet of biscuits. Items made during a craft session can be taken home or left behind to be sold for charity.

Visit www.opengatewaycraftclub.webs.com or call 020 8836 9069 for more information or to find out where you can buy the group's homemade crafts and cards.

POP IN DURING 2011!

The Pop in Parlour is a great over 55's club based at Evenlode House, Coralline Walk, Thamesmead. Join in the fun including bingo, coach trips and games of bowls on the onsite bowling green. Regulars at the Pop in Parlour also take part in trips and outings and recently 70 members of the club enjoyed a coach trip and Christmas lunch in Canterbury. The centre is open from 10am until 2pm Monday to Friday, with lunch available at reasonable prices from 12 noon. Contact John Thompson on 0208 310 7437 to find out more.

DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

CHINESE NEW YEAR - 6 FEBRUARY

Celebrate the year of the rabbit in Central London. The festivities will include traditional and contemporary Chinese entertainment in Trafalgar Square as well as cultural stalls, food, decorations and lion dance displays in Chinatown. Visit www.london.gov.uk or call 020 7983 4000 for more information.

CANARY WHARF FASHION WEEKEND 17-20 FEBRUARY

Why not celebrate London Fashion Week with a visit to Canary Wharf for an exclusive weekend of fashion? Catwalk shows will showcase the best of Canary Wharf's fashion stores. This is a free event and it will take place at Jubilee Place. Visit www.mycanarywharf.com or call 020 7477 1477 for further details.

FAMILY FUN AND BENEFITS DAY - 23 FEBRUARY

Come along to our free event to get advice about benefits, tax credits, debts and budgeting. Plus you will be able to enjoy fun activities for all the family, including face painting, arts and crafts, balloon modelling and free refreshments. This event will take place at Manor Close Community Centre and will run from 10:30am until 7:30pm. We hope to see you there! Call us on 0800 83 84 81 for more information.

160 YEARS OF THE CENSUS IN BEXLEY - 24 MARCH

Join this free talk at Erith Library, 100 Erith High Street to find out about your local history and how the area has changed over time. This free event runs from 2pm until 3pm. To book a place call 020 8303 7777 (option 4). Read more about the census on page three.

Editor's note: Thamesview does not endorse or recommend any clubs, groups or events listed. We aim to provide accurate and up to date information but cannot be held responsible for any misleading or inaccurate information supplied to us.

A	E	D	P	F	C	G	R	J	T	K	L	L
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S	L	U	A	P	T	S	I	D	U	S	L	A
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WIN WITH OUR LONDON WORDSEARCH

In this wordsearch we have hidden the names of six popular London attractions. Find them all and you could win a £30 Morrisons voucher.

BIG BEN
HARRODS
HYDE PARK
LONDON EYE
ST PAULS
TATE MODERN

DID YOU KNOW...

The London Eye is 135m high which is equivalent to 64 red telephone boxes piled on top of each other!

With an average of 3.75 million visitors a year, the London Eye receives more visitors annually than ancient wonders of the world such as the Taj Mahal, Stonehenge and even the Great Pyramids of Giza.

Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London, SE2 9BR or drop it into our reception by 28th February 2011. The winner will be selected at random.

Name: .....

Address: .....

.....

.....

Telephone: .....

Email: .....

Congratulations to Mr Leman of Lipton Close who was the winner of our last wordsearch competition.

Tenants' View



Our regular resident editor, Adrian Gogerly, has taken a break from his role due to work commitments so I will be editing Tenants View for him until he returns. I am a member of the Gallions Residents Group and a previous editor of The Voice magazine.

We have had some good feedback about Tenants View so far but please keep your stories coming in and let me know about any issues that you want to share with other residents.

I hope you had a happy Christmas and wishing you a prosperous 2011.

Ray Woodage
Acting Resident Editor

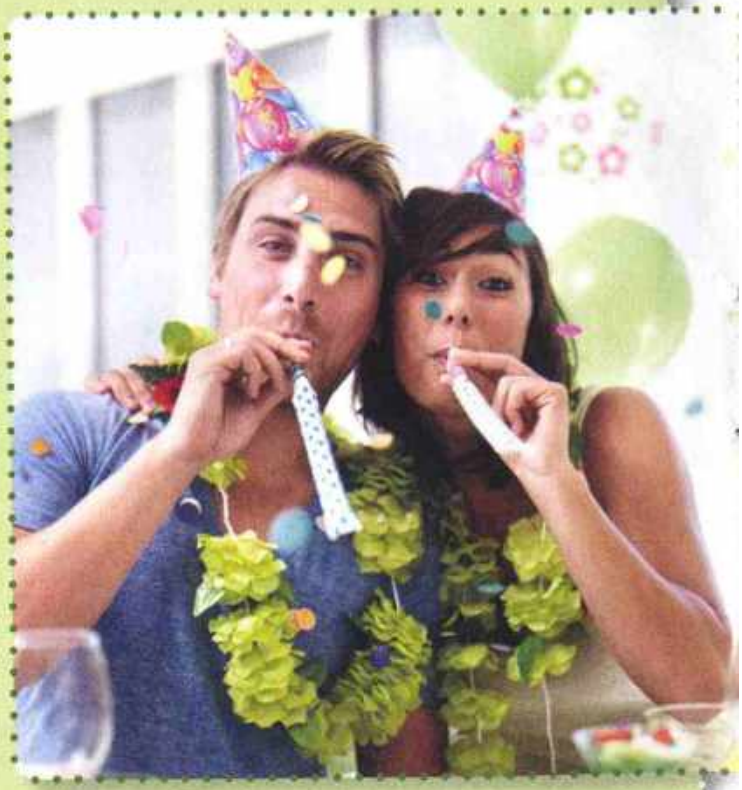
Party time!

There will be lots to celebrate in 2011 and 2012, with the Royal Wedding, the Queen's Diamond Jubilee and the Olympics coming to London. Some of you might like to run a traditional street party or a smaller 'street meet' so you can enjoy the special occasions with others in your area.

For more advice about bringing your street to life visit www.streetparty.co.uk, call Streets Alive on 0117 922 5708 or speak to your local council.

Please make sure you have the relevant insurance and permissions before organising your party.

Adrian



Grants up for grabs!

The Gallions Residents Group (GRG) has grants available for groups or projects that will benefit Gallions' residents in Thamesmead and other areas. Applications don't need to be related to housing issues, we will consider all areas of work that will enhance the lives of residents.

So if you run a group for local people or have a great idea for a community event please contact Helen Chambers, GRG Officer on 0800 83 84 81 or email hchambers@gallionsha.co.uk to apply.

Dave

New look Furniture Bank

The Gallions Residents Group has been running the Furniture Bank at Tavy Bridge for over a year now to help residents recycle their unwanted furniture within the community.



The scheme has been a fantastic success so an independent group has been set up to run the Furniture Bank, although the initiative will still be supported by Gallions and Trust Thamesmead.

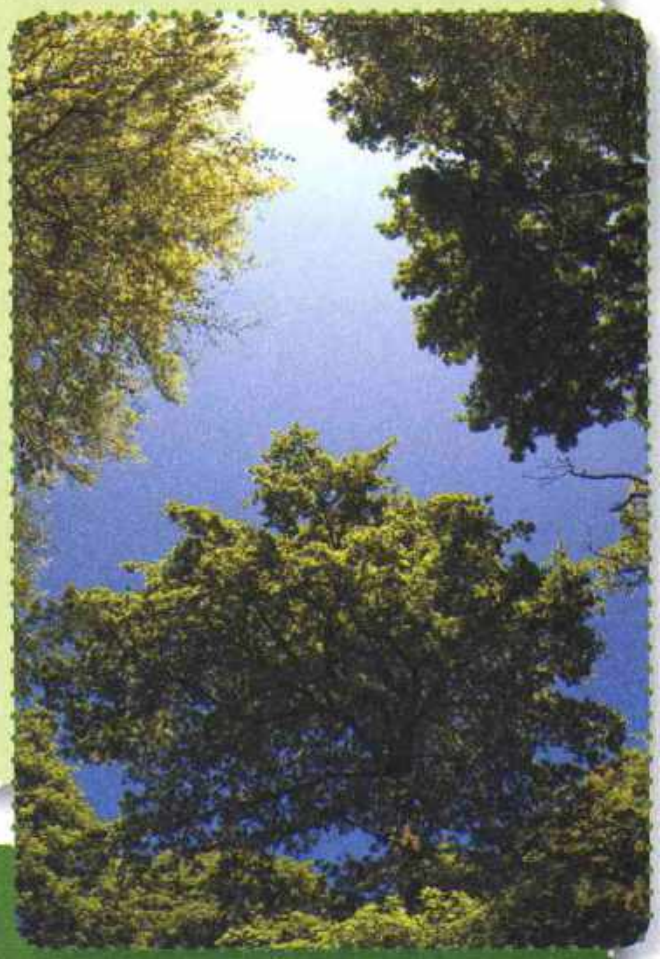
The Furniture Bank has now been re-named as Thamesmead Furniture Recycle. There will be some service changes in the coming months and we hope to open more often. Users of the service will also be asked to make a donation towards the furniture and for pick up or delivery.

If you would like to help this new group, either by volunteering your time or donating your good quality unwanted furniture, please contact Linda Delieu at Trust Thamesmead on 020 8320 4470.

Ray

Tenants' View

Tree's a crowd!



With spring just around the corner it is important to let Gallions know if a tree near you becomes overgrown or dangerous. You should contact them on 0800 83 84 81 and they will arrange for a member of staff to assess the tree.

Staff can see if the tree needs to be pruned or cut down and will complete the most urgent works first. For example, if a tree and its branches are unstable and likely to endanger someone this will be dealt with as a priority.

Claudette

Charity bags

Many residents have been receiving charity bags at home that can be filled with unwanted clothes and left outside for collection. Often these bags are provided by independent companies who collect on behalf of charities and give a set fee or percentage of their profits to the charity.

If you would like to make a donation using the bags please check the charity or company number on the bag to make sure it is from a reputable organisation and read the small print to see how much will be going to the advertised charity. You can check online at www.charity-commission.gov.uk or www.companieshouse.gov.uk or call the charity directly to make sure the bags are legitimate.

The best option is often to take your unwanted items directly to a charity shop or your local clothes recycling bank.

Adrian



Quicker queries

Gallions has invested in a Geographic Information System (GIS) to help capture detailed information about Thamesmead, which includes who owns the trees, grass, hard surfaces, shrubs and more.

This new system will help residents who have a query or complaint because Gallions staff will be able to deal with issues more efficiently. This is an ongoing project but I hope you will notice an improvement in service.

Ray

Decent Homes for Gallions' residents



The 31st December 2010 was the deadline by which all properties owned and managed by councils and housing associations had to meet the 'Decent Homes Standard'. This standard, which was set by the government, states that all social housing should be warm and weatherproof with reasonably modern facilities.

We are pleased to say that all Gallions homes have met this standard. Gallions also operates a planned home improvement programme to maintain and update your home. Contact the Asset Management Team on 0800 83 84 81 or visit www.gallionsha.co.uk to find out more.

Adrian

Tenants' View

Do you want to influence change?

Gallions Residents Group (GRG) is made up of committed volunteers who work with Gallions to monitor services on behalf of residents. Members are invited to sit on various groups within Gallions to give a resident's perspective on activities and decisions.

We have a number of vacancies within the GRG and invite all interested tenants, leaseholders and charge payers to apply. Applications from Gallions residents outside Thamesmead would be particularly welcome. We are holding two taster sessions next month so you can find out what the group does. So please join us on:

Tuesday 15 February 10.00am to 12.00pm at the Gallions office in Harrow Manor Way, Thamesmead.

Thursday 24 February 6.30pm to 8.30pm at the GRG office, the Atrium, Teeswater Court, Middle Way, Thamesmead.

Deborah *(Gallions Residents Group Chair)*



The snow is falling...

We have had quite a bad winter so far but with thanks to Team Gallions most residents have still been able to get out and about.

During snowy and icy conditions Team Gallions work hard to spread grit in priority areas such as older person blocks, slopes, stairs and busy locations. If you have an area near you that is particularly icy or inaccessible please contact us 0800 83 84 81 and we will try our best to make it safer for you. The team can only treat the areas which belong to Gallions.

Your local council also provides a winter maintenance service to deal with ice and snow situations so you can also contact them about issues where you live.

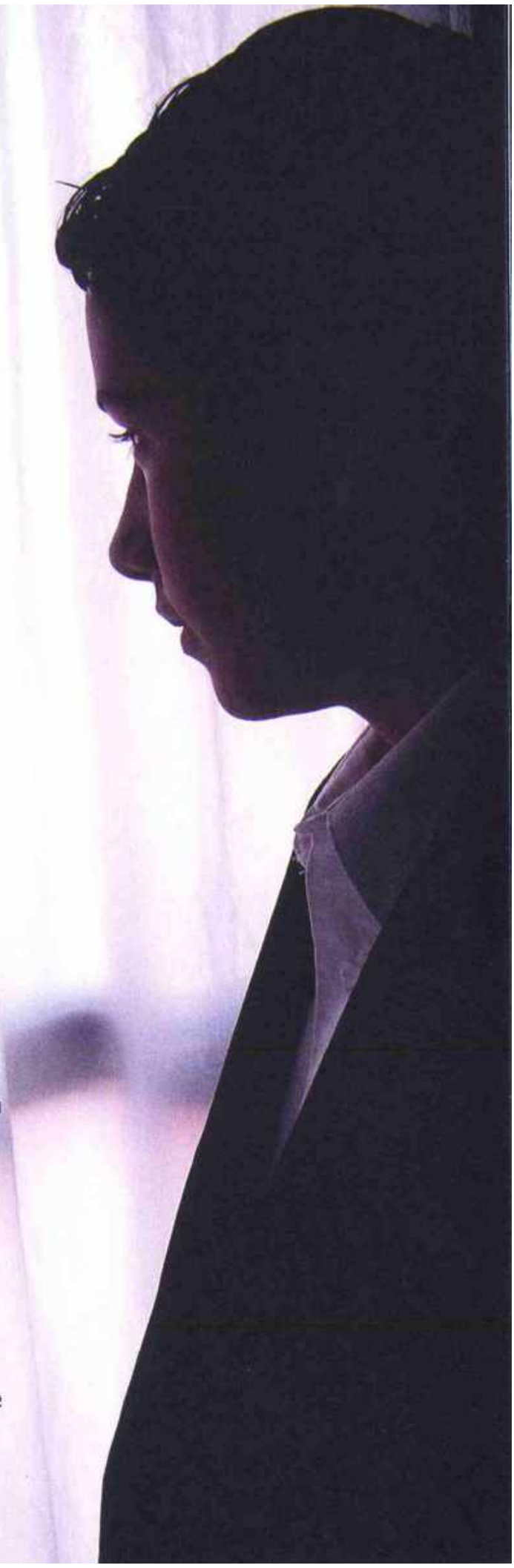
Marlene

UPDATE ON SUB-LETTING

During 2010 we recovered 50 properties which had been illegally sub-let by the original tenants. Our Enforcement Team are currently investigating a number of new cases which have been referred to us. All our recovered properties have now been re-let to people who are eligible for housing with us.

We have received a great deal of information from residents and this has been extremely useful so please keep your reports coming in. If you suspect that one of our homes is being sub-let call us on 0800 83 84 81, visit our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk or speak to a member of staff.

You don't have to provide your contact details but if you do we will let you know the outcome of our investigations.



LOOKING AFTER YOUR NEIGHBOURHOOD

Help us keep your streets clean and prevent dog fouling by reporting owners who fail to clean up after their pets.

If there is a dog fouling problem in your neighbourhood contact us on 0800 83 84 81 and we will look into it. Often our Neighbourhood Wardens will be able to patrol the area but they need information to help them target their patrols. So when you make a report please tell us:

- The days of the week when offences are taking place
- The time that offences are taking place
- Where the offences happen
- A description of the owner
- A description of the dog
- If the owner is using a car, the vehicle registration number

If you are a dog owner please make sure you clear up after your animal or you could be issued with a Fixed Penalty Notice. You should:

- Where possible dispose of dog mess in a designated dog waste bin
- If you can't find a dog waste bin, bag your pet's mess and take it home for disposal
- If no other option is available pick up any mess and seal it well using a bag which can then be carefully placed in a standard public litter bin



METER CREDIT SCAM

The Police are warning residents about a scam in which criminals offer cut price energy to those with pre-payment meters.

There is only one safe and secure way to buy credit for your pre-pay electricity meter and that is by using official outlets such as the Post Office, PayPoint or Payzone.

If someone calls at your door don't be tempted to take on the offer of a top up as you might pay for it twice; once to the criminal and then to your energy company.

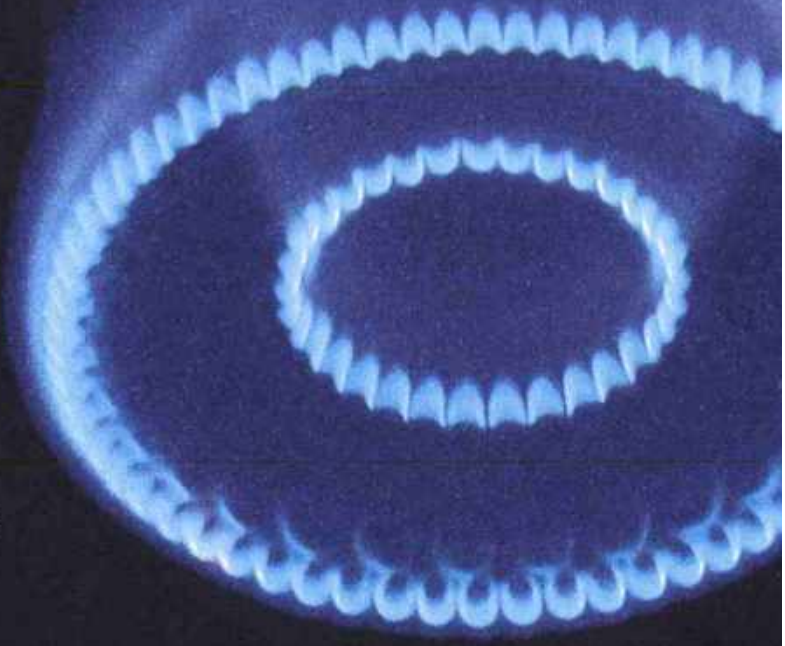
If you know anyone selling electricity meter top-ups illegally, contact Crimestoppers anonymously on 0800 555 111. To find out more visit www.top-upsafe.com.

GAS SAFETY CHECKS

From this month we will be trialling a new programme for gas safety checks so that residents will have a check every 10 months instead of 12.

This means that you may receive a letter about your next check from our contactor, Interserve sooner than expected.

Please do not ignore the letter and try to keep the offered appointment. If you need to re-arrange the appointment please contact Interserve directly using the contact details on your letter.





NEIGHBOURHOOD BLOCK INSPECTIONS

Every month we run Neighbourhood Block Inspections. If you want to join in call us on 0800 83 84 81 to find out where and what time to meet. Here are our latest dates; check online at www.gallionsha.co.uk for more information.

Abbey Wood

8 February
St Josephs Court, Felixstowe Road
22 March
St Josephs Court, Felixstowe Road

Broadwaters

2 February
Bridge House, Tump House, Hill House
9 February
Whinchat Road, Wren Path
10 February
Wigeon Path, Redwing Path
16 March
Bridge House, Tump House, Hill House
23 March
Whinchat Road, Wren Path
24 March
Wigeon Path, Redwing Path

Crossway

16 February
Phoenix Point, Ringside Court
18 March
Phoenix Point, Ringside Court

Greenmead

14 March
Lime Row

Lesnes

14 February
Coralline Walk, Evenlode House
15 February
Clewer House, Maplin House, Wyfold House
22 February
Hibernia House, Radley House, Duxford House
18 March
Clewer House, Maplin House, Wyfold House
28 March
Coralline Walk, Evenlode House

Moorings

24 February
Harold Wilson House
2 March
Simon Court, Chadwick Court, Manning Court
3 March
Besant Court, Mill Court, Cross Court
9 March
Keynes Court, Webb Court, Raymond Postgate Court



10 March
Lansbury Court, Beveridge Court

Parkview
7 February
Shire Court, Teeswater Court, Buckwheat Court
21 February
Maran Way, Argali House, Dexter House, Harlequin House
28 February
Masham House, Jacob House, Clydesdale House
1 March
Trefoil House, Timothy House, Muscovy House
21 March
Shire Court, Teeswater Court, Buckwheat Court

Slade Green
8 February
Old Church Court
22 March
Old Church Court

Southmere
1 February
Oakenholt House, Trewsbury House, Penton House, Osney House
7 March
Tavy Bridge, Binsey Walk
8 March
Tilehurst Point, Blewbury House
14 March
Deal Court, Staplehurst Court
15 March
Oakenholt House, Trewsbury House, Penton House, Osney House

Tower Hamlets
3 February
Millharbour, St Annes
17 March
Millharbour, St Annes

Waterfield
17 February
Cobden Court, Bright Court, Hazlitt Court
23 February
Shaftesbury Court, Wilberforce Court, Kingsley Court
24 February
Disraeli Close
25 March
Cobden Court, Bright Court, Hazlitt Court

HOW WELL ARE WE DOING?

Our latest performance chart shows our performance as a landlord from 1st April 2010 until 30th November 2010. If you would like to join our residents group and help us monitor and improve what we do please contact Helen Chambers on 0800 83 84 81.

Description	April 09 - March 10	April 10 - Nov 10	Target	Performance Trend	Current Status
Overall satisfaction with service	77%	82%	75%	↑	☺
Void re-let period	34 days	28.9 days	28 days	↑	☹
Emergency repairs completed within timescale	99.6%	99.85%	98%	↑	☺
Urgent and routine repairs completed within timescale	98.1%	99.60%	97%	↑	☺
Calls answered within 20 seconds	84%	84.51%	80%	↑	☺
Complaints answered within timescale	92.9%	93.34%	90%	↑	☺
Satisfaction with anti-social behaviour process	77.9%	94%	80%	↑	☺
Rent collected	98.7%	101.00%	99%	↑	☺

Performance Status			Overall Performance Trend
☹	Performance is below target	↑	Performance is better than last year
☺	Performance is above target	↓	Performance is worse than last year
		↔	Performance is the same as last year

HOMEOWNER NEWS

Extending your lease

A lease is the right to use a property for a period of time, normally between 99 and 125 years. As a lease gets shorter it becomes more expensive to extend and it can be difficult to sell a property with a short lease. The cost of a lease extension increases substantially when there are less than 80 years remaining.

If you would like to extend your lease you will need to pay your solicitor's fees, the valuation fee and Gallions' solicitor fees. You will also have to pay a fee for the lease extension, which will be agreed between the valuers, Gallions and the leaseholder. If you decide to proceed with the lease extension, you will be asked to pay a deposit, which would be 10% of the valuation or £250, whichever is greater.

Homeowner Surgeries

If you would you like more information about lease extension, home improvements, sub-letting, setting up a tenant group or help with paying your bills come along to a homeowner surgery at our office in Harrow Manor Way. Visit our reception, call 0800 83 84 81 or email homeownerteam@gallionsha.co.uk to make an appointment.

Important gas safety information

Do you have a gas boiler that is located on an internal wall? If so you may have a 'concealed flue'. Whilst concealed flues are safe, they do require special consideration when you have your boiler serviced, which usually means having special access points in your ceiling or the flue.

It is all the more important if you have a concealed flue to install a carbon monoxide alarm that will detect any problems. You can buy an alarm at most DIY shops or online. You should also have your appliances properly installed and maintained by a Gas Safe Registered engineer.

YOUR PERSONAL INFORMATION



At Gallions we hold personal information about our tenants. The Data Protection Act states that we are required to compile, store and dispose of this information with great care. When we ask you for personal data we have to ensure it is clear where the request has come from and why the information is needed.

Gallions will also ask you for personal details including gender, disabilities (if any), sexual orientation, gender reassignment (if relevant), race, date of birth, religion/belief so that we can make sure your service needs are met.

For more details about how we process your information view our 'Fair Processing Statement' on our website or request a copy from Jane Lester, Gallions Company Secretary on 0800 83 84 81.

Sometimes Gallions will need to disclose your personal data to third parties – but we won't do this unless:

- We are required to by law (for the prevention of crime)
- There is an Information Sharing Protocol in place to ensure that any processing by the third party will be within the law
- It is necessary to fulfil a legitimate purpose and you have been told

Some of the purposes for which Gallions currently shares your data are:

- To allow contractors to provide services such as the collection of rent payments and maintenance of your home
- For insurance purposes
- For training and/or research purposes
- For legal purposes - i.e. providing information to solicitors or other advocates in case of dispute

Gallions also intends to participate in the National Fraud Initiative (NFI) which has been set up by the Audit Commission (and any successor body) in order to protect public funds. This means that your information may be used in 'Data Matching'.

Data Matching involves comparing computer records held by one body against other computer records held by the same or another body to see how far they match. This is usually personal information. Computerised Data Matching allows fraudulent claims and payments to be identified. If a match is found it shows that there is an inconsistency to be investigated. An investigation could reveal an error, fraud or another explanation.

Working with the NFI will assist in the prevention and detection of fraud against Gallions and other organisations within the public sector. We will provide the Audit Commission with particular sets of data for matching as set out in the Audit Commission's guidance which can be found at www.audit-commission.gov.uk/nfi or you can call 0844 798 3131.

NOTICEBOARD

New neighbourhood noticeboards

We have been working with other local organisations to install new community noticeboards across our neighbourhoods in Thamesmead. We will be working with Trust Thamesmead to put the latest community news, events and information on the boards so please check them out. If you notice any grafitti or damage to the noticeboards please let us know on 0800 83 84 81.

You said, we did!

We have recently changed the way we work due to customer feedback and complaints.

We received a complaint about how we dealt with communal repairs so we ran a specific communal repairs training session for staff. We also changed the questions that our call centre staff ask when you tell us about a problem in your block to make sure we can get things fixed as quickly as possible.

We have changed the form our contractors use when you tell us your preferences for planned home improvements (like new kitchens and bathrooms). On the new form residents are asked to check and put their initials next to their choice. This helps us place the right order every time.

If you have a complaint, comment or compliment please contact us on 0800 83 84 81 or visit www.gallionsha.co.uk.

Congratulations Claudette!



We are really proud of Gallions Residents Group member Claudette Lawrence, who was recently nominated for two community awards.

Claudette is an active campaigner for mental health charities and volunteers for the local neighbourhood watch programme despite having health problems.

Claudette placed 21st out of 290 nominees for the Community Channel's Community Champion Award and was nominated for the RETHINK Pringle Award for Activist of the Year.

Well done Claudette! If you know about an inspiring member of the community please let us know so we can help celebrate their successes. Email thamesview@gallionsha.co.uk or call Anita Dagger on 0800 83 84 81.

We offer a comprehensive translation service to make communicating with us easy. If you would like Thamesview Magazine translated into your own language or need an audio, large print or Braille version please contact us.

☎: 0800 83 84 81
✉: translations@gallionsha.co.uk

Chúng tôi cung cấp dịch vụ biên dịch cho tất cả các loại ngôn ngữ để giúp quí vị dễ dàng liên lạc với chúng tôi. Nếu quí vị muốn cuốn Tạp chí Thamesview này được dịch sang ngôn ngữ của quí vị hoặc quí vị cần một phiên bản khác bằng âm thanh, in khổ lớn hoặc Chữ nổi, xin hãy liên hệ với chúng tôi.

我們提供廣泛的語言翻譯服務，令您能更方便地與我們交流。如果您需要將「Thamesview 雜誌」翻譯為您所使用的語言，或需要音訊版本、大字體印刷版本或盲文版本，請與我們取得聯繫。

ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਪੱਤਰ-ਵਿਹਾਰ ਨੂੰ ਅਸਾਨ ਬਨਾਉਣ ਲਈ ਅਸੀਂ ਇੱਕ ਵਿਆਪਕ ਅਨੁਵਾਦ ਸੇਵਾ ਪੇਸ਼ ਕਰਦੇ ਹਾਂ। ਜੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਥੇਮਜ਼ਵਿਊ ਮੈਗਜ਼ੀਨ ਦਾ ਆਪਣੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਵਿੱਚ ਅਨੁਵਾਦ ਕਰਵਾਉਣਾ ਚਾਹੋ ਜਾਂ ਤੁਹਾਨੂੰ ਆਡੀਓ, ਵੱਡੇ ਅੱਖਰਾਂ ਜਾਂ ਬ੍ਰੇਲ ਵਿੱਚ ਰੂਪਾਂਤਰ ਚਾਹੀਦਾ ਹੋਵੇ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਤਾਂ ਕਰਕੇ ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਸੰਪਰਕ ਕਰੋ।

আমরা আমাদের সাথে যোগাযোগ সহজ করার জন্য একটি ব্যাপক অনুবাদ পরিষেবা প্রদান করে থাকি। আপনি যদি টেমসভিউ ম্যাগাজিনকে আপনার মাতৃভাষায় অনুবাদ হিসেবে পেতে চান বা একটি অডিও, বড় হরফের মুদ্রন বা ব্রেইল রূপ পেতে চান অনুগ্রহ করে আমাদের সাথে যোগাযোগ করুন।

Getting to know you!

Late last year we started sending out getting to know you surveys to residents so we can find out a bit more about who lives in our homes.

The Tenants Services Authority (our regulator) asks us to collect this information and we use it to make sure we deliver high quality services tailored to your needs and that we treat our tenants fairly and equally.

We will be sending the remaining surveys out over the coming year so please fill it in when you receive it.

Door entry at Maran Way

We will be installing new door entry and CCTV systems in Maran Way this month to improve security for residents.

We wanted to offer extra security measures in this area due to feedback from residents.

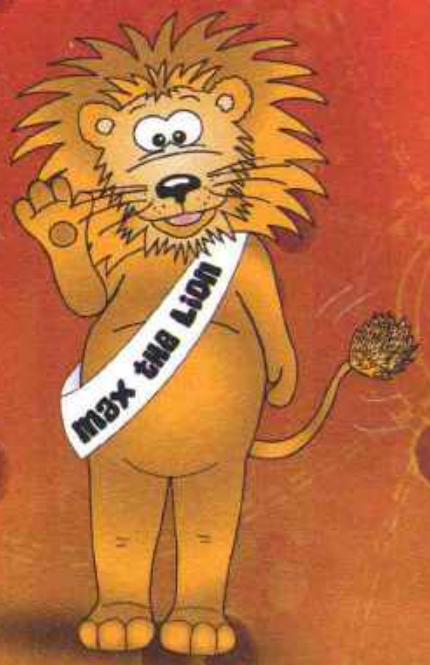
To find out more about planned maintenance and improvements where you live visit our website or call us on 0800 83 84 81.

Kidsview

SUNNY SPRINGTIME WORDSEARCH

It's nearly springtime so we have hidden six names for baby animals in this wordsearch. Find them all and you could win a wildlife fun pack!

Z	N	X	E	C	E	V	O	B	F	B	A	N
M	M	I	L	S	K	D	J	F	H	G	J	G
F	J	D	H	P	U	P	P	Y	D	W	S	E
R	C	T	T	Y	G	U	R	I	T	O	R	P
S	G	D	O	F	T	G	C	H	I	J	A	L
A	Z	N	X	P	C	C	V	I	B	Q	G	A
Z	A	E	R	C	L	A	M	B	U	N	N	M
J	S	T	F	G	L	L	S	D	G	S	I	A
K	X	T	P	L	O	F	I	S	U	M	L	C
A	P	I	G	L	E	T	I	G	E	H	K	J
M	Z	K	X	E	C	V	X	B	D	N	C	M
A	A	E	E	F	L	V	T	H	D	C	U	O
P	W	D	R	G	G	N	S	U	F	T	D	Q



Calf
Duckling
Kitten
Lamb
Piglet
Puppy

This competition is just for kids under 12. Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE66 91 London, SE2 9BR or drop it into our reception by 28th February 2011. The winner will be selected at random.

Child's name:

Parent's name:

Address:

Telephone:

Well done to Mollie Morris of Wolvercote Road who was the winner of our last competition.